

# Basics of Computers

Ilaria Tiddi

16. September 2024

Recap

# Lectures

## **Guest lectures (70% of the exam questions)**

Still to come:

- Peter Bloem (Machine Learning)
- Guszti Eiben (Computational Intelligence)
- Koen Hindriks (Social AI)
- Stefan Schlobach (Ethical AI)
- Benno Kruit (Data processing and Engineering)
- Ilaria Tiddi (Hybrid Intelligence)

# Lectures

## **Methodology Lectures (30% of the exam questions)**

### Steps

- ~~1. Determining the problem~~
- ~~2. Finding Literature~~
3. Basics of computers
4. Methods in AI (approach/solution)
5. Empirical Evaluations
6. Mathematics for AI (Discrete)

# Final (Report) Assignment

12 pages scientific report (LNCS template)

- Abstract (1 page)
- Introduction (1 page)
- What is the problem? (2 pages) ← *just submitted*
- What has been done? (3 pages) ← *literature due Sept 22*
- How can the problem be solved? (3 pages max) ← *approach/method due Sept 29*
- Is the solution valid? (2 pages) ← *evaluation due Oct 6*
- Conclusion (1page)

Where are we?

# Where are we?

1. Defining the problem
2. Finding related work
3. **Building an AI system**
4. Evaluation of an AI system

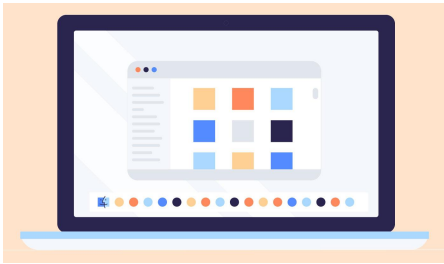
# What do you need to build an AI system?





# What are these?

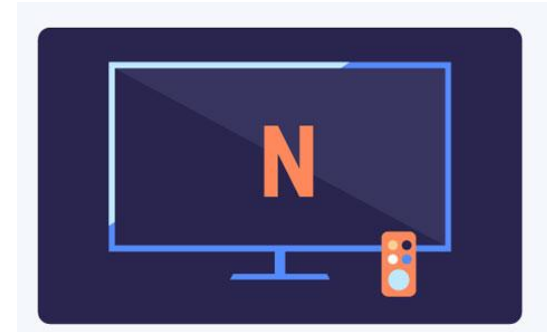
A



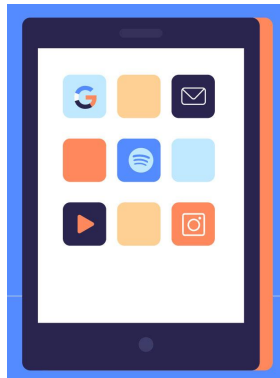
B



C



D

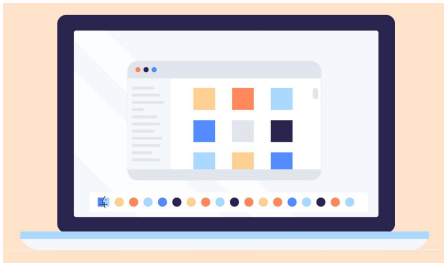


E



# What do they have in common?

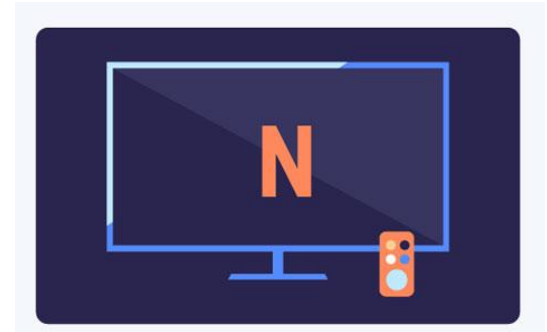
A



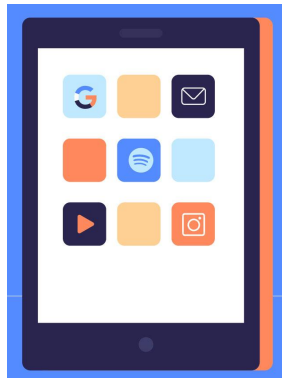
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D



E



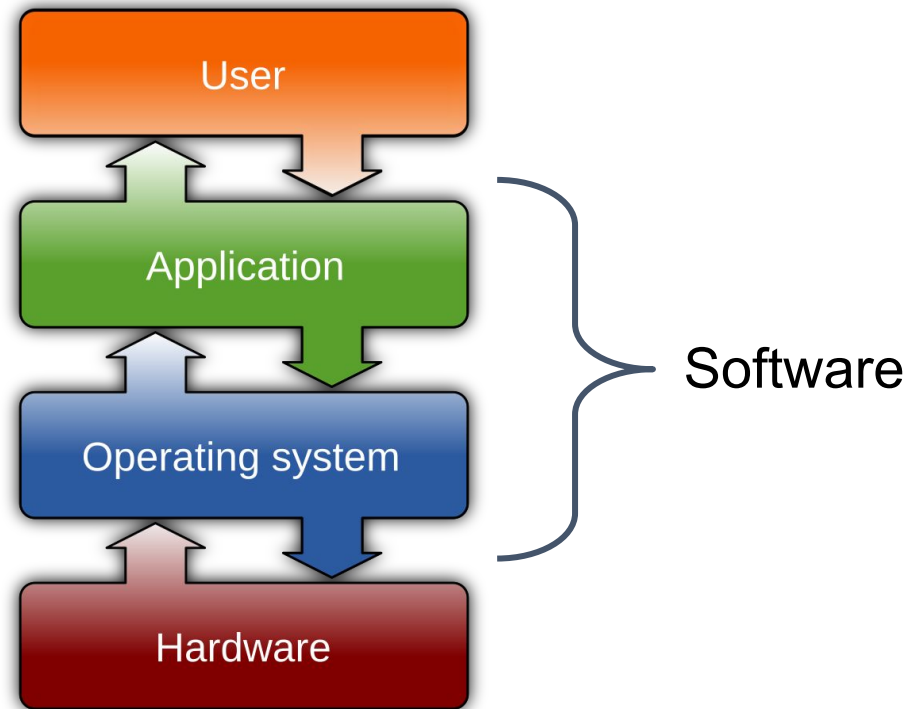
# Computers

Any system device that manipulates (= stores, retrieves, processes) data.



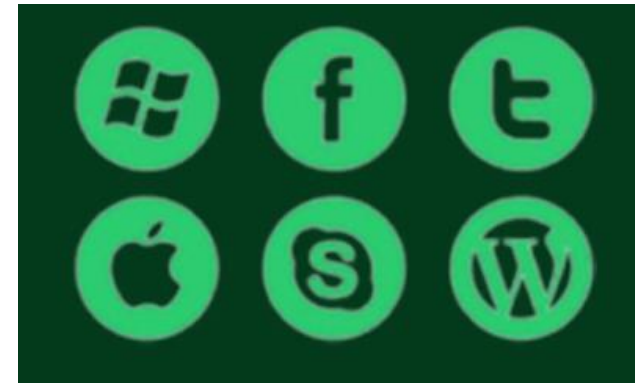
Source : <https://edu.gcfglobal.org/en/computerbasics/what-is-a-computer/1/>

# Computer Architecture



Source : <https://edu.gcfglobal.org/en/computerbasics/what-is-a-computer/1/>

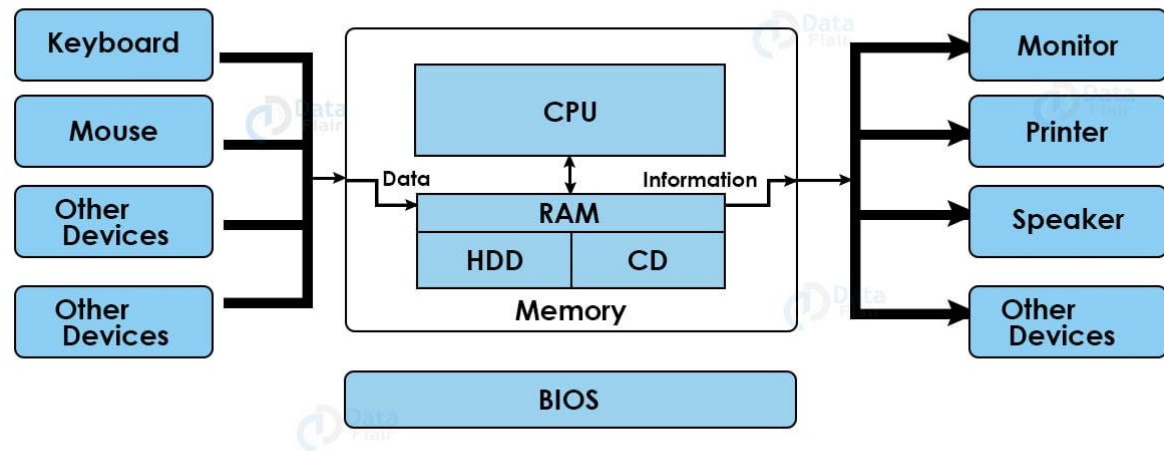
# Hardware vs. Software?



Source : <https://www.lifewire.com/computer-hardware-2625895>

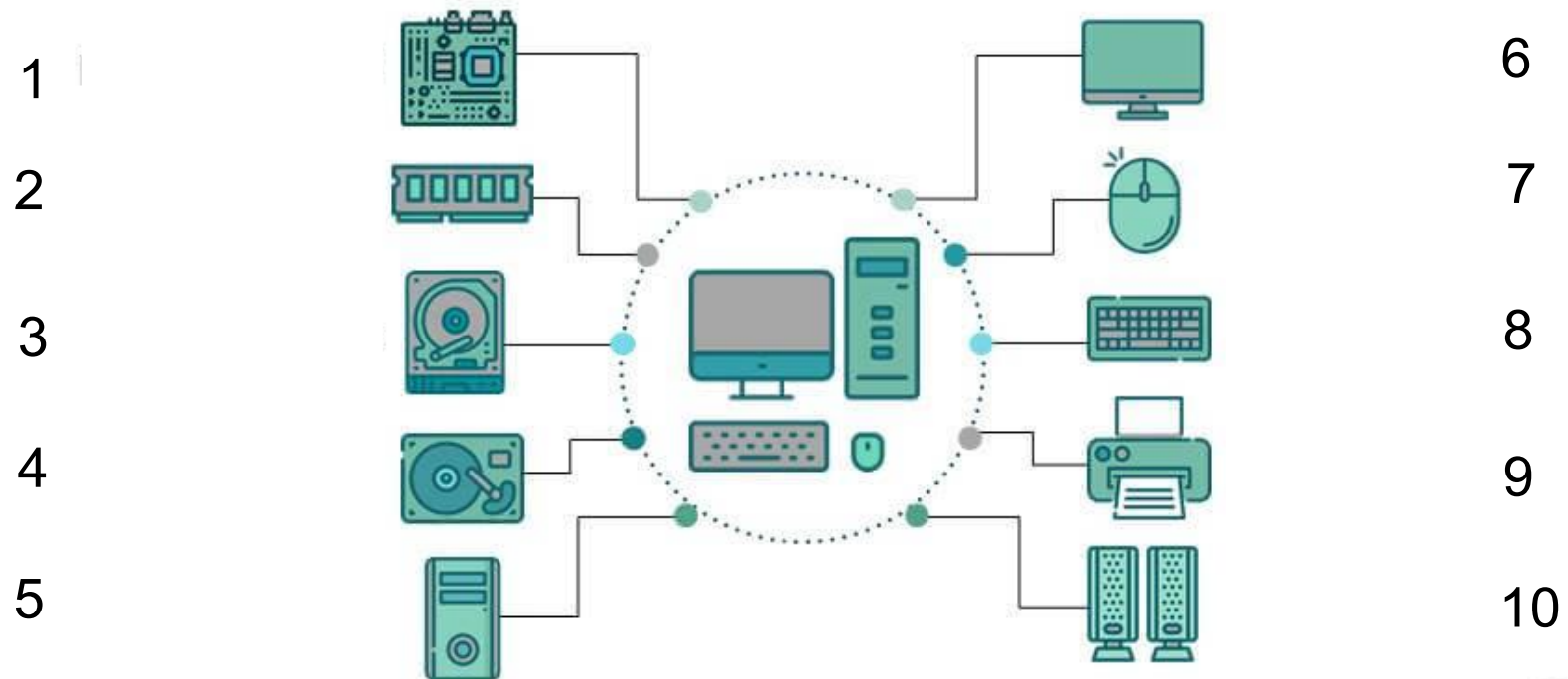
# Hardware

1. Peripheral devices
2. Input devices
3. Output devices
4. Internal Components



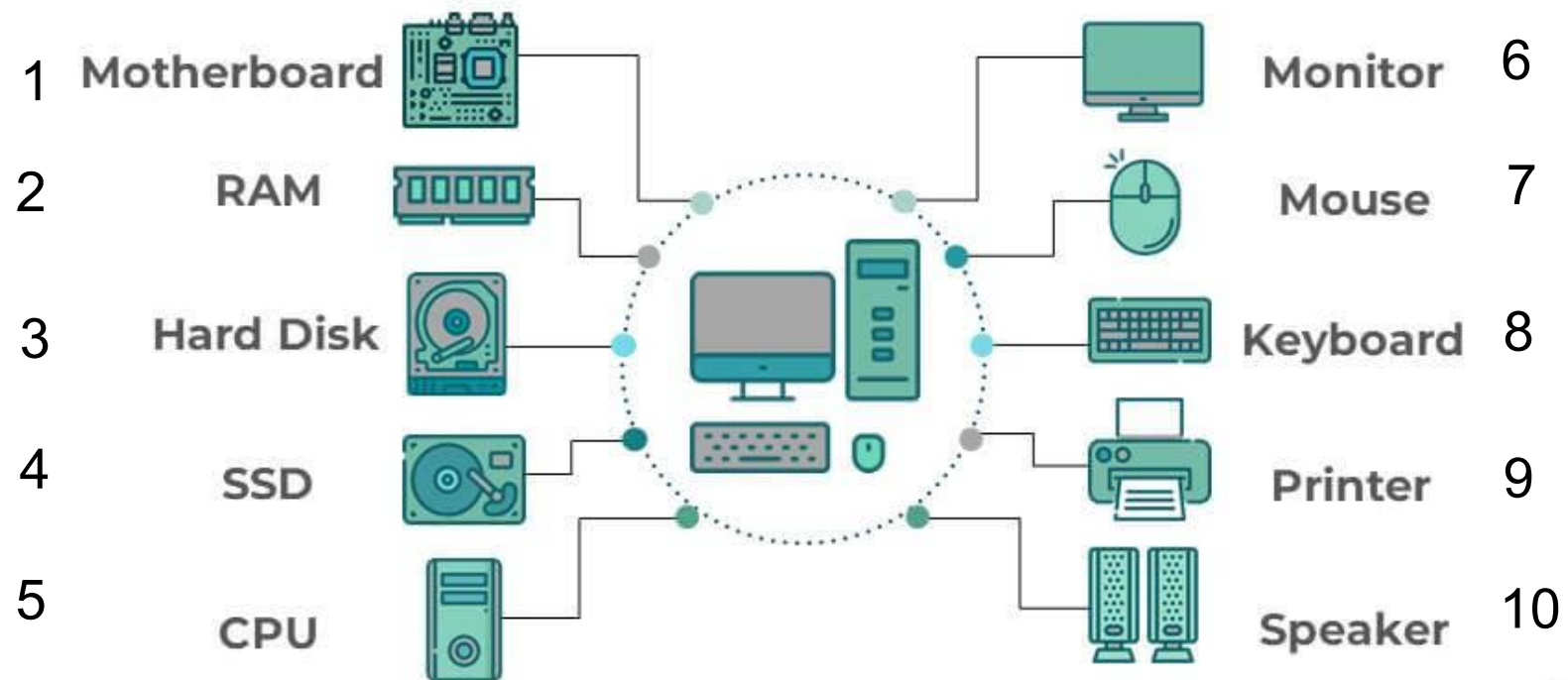
Source : <https://data-flair.training/blogs/basics-of-computer-hardware-and-software/>

# Hardware



Source : <https://www.educba.com/types-of-computer-hardware/>

# Hardware



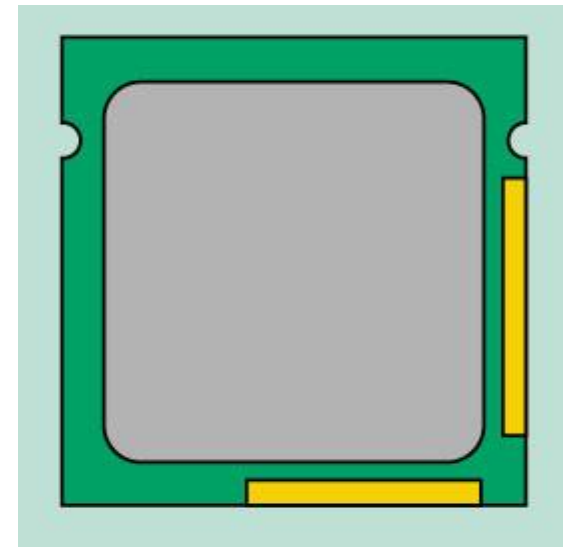
Source : <https://www.educba.com/types-of-computer-hardware/>



# Hardware

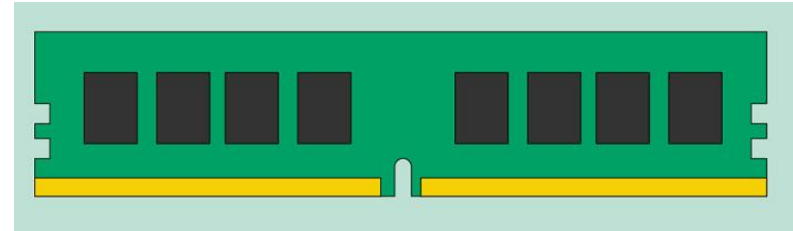
## Processors/ CPUs

- **calculations and operations** on the data
- execute instructions
- Arithmetic and Logical Unit **ALU**: (addition, subtraction, multiplication, division and also making logical decisions like  $>$  or  $<$  , etc)
- Control Unit **CU**: execution of the tasks



Source : <https://edu.gcfglobal.org/en/computerbasics/what-is-a-computer/1/>

# Hardware



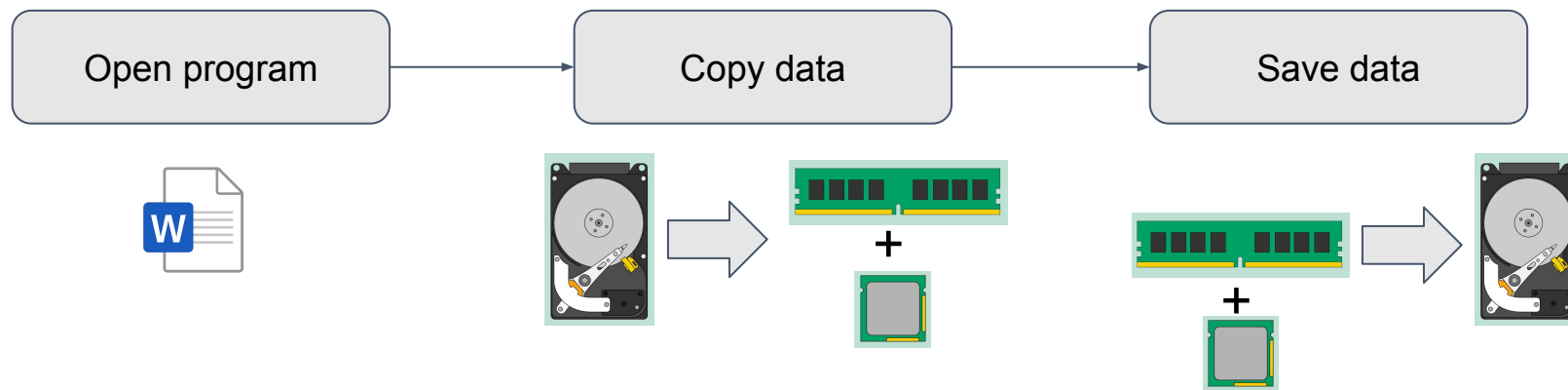
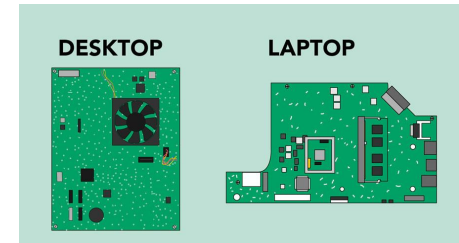
## Memory / **RAM**:

- Main, primary memory of the computer
- Stores data and instructions, while the processing is taking place in the CPU.
- **volatile** (data is lost when the power is disconnected)
- How do you measure RAM ?

Another primary memory is ROM (Read Only Memory).

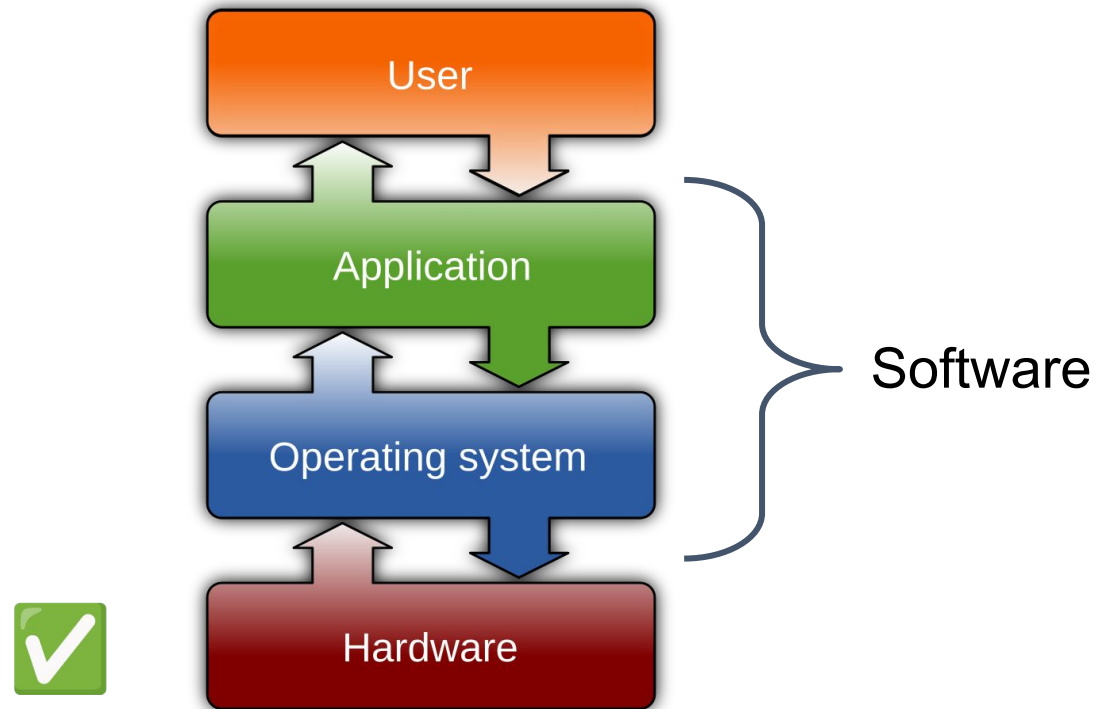
# Hardware

- Motherboard: holds CPU, GPU, RAM, connectors
- Hard Disk & Solid State Disk (SSD): long state storage



Source : <https://edu.gcfglobal.org/en/computerbasics/what-is-a-computer/1/>

# Computer Architecture



Source : Wikipedia (operating system)

# Software

Set of programs written to perform special tasks or functions on a computer.

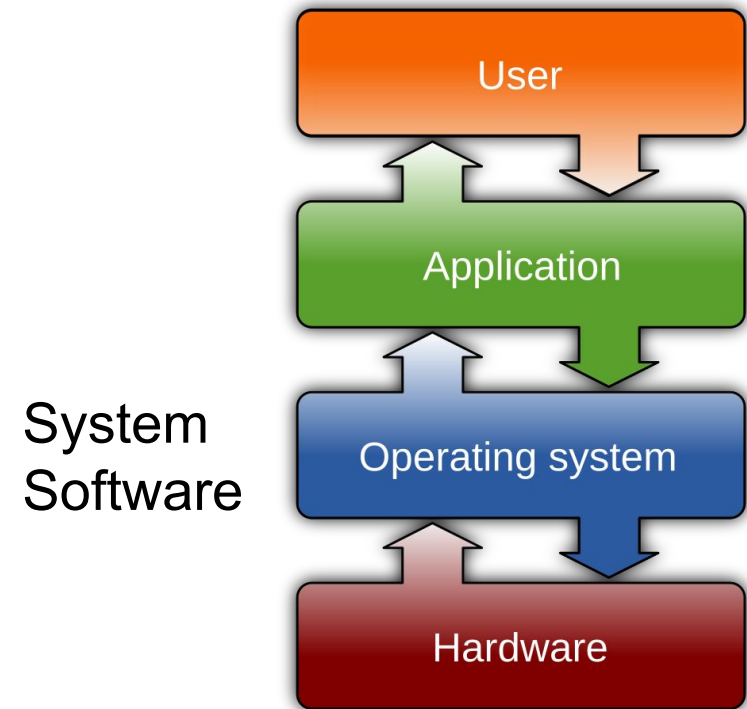
1. System Software : **Necessary software** to operate a device
2. Application Software : **Not necessary** to operate
  - Text processors
  - Web browsers
  - Media players
  - Games

**NB** : WebApps vs. Desktop App

# Operating Systems

An OS is a software used for interaction between the user and the computer hardware.

Give 4 examples?



# Operating Systems

- Microsoft Windows
- MacOS
- Linux
- Android (let op!)

## Types:

- Command Line
- GUI



Source : <https://computerscience.chemeketa.edu/cs160Reader/OperatingSystems/OperatingSystems.html>

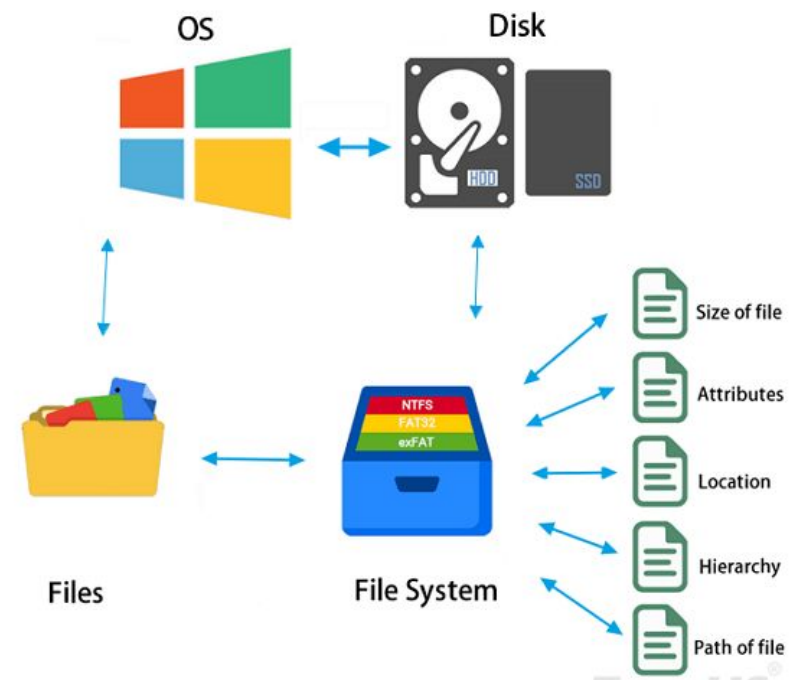
# File systems

A **structure** used by an OS to organise and manage files on a storage device (HD, SSD, USB)

It defines how data is stored, accessed, and **organised on the storage** device.

Files, Directories, Metadata (name, size, metadata)

NB Your phone is also a file system!



Source : <https://www.easeus.com/diskmanager/file-system.html>



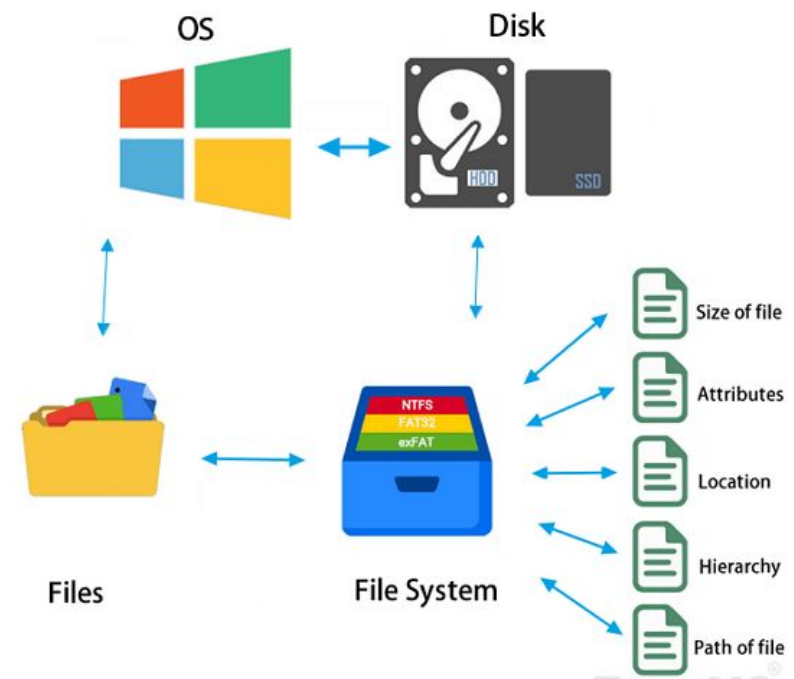
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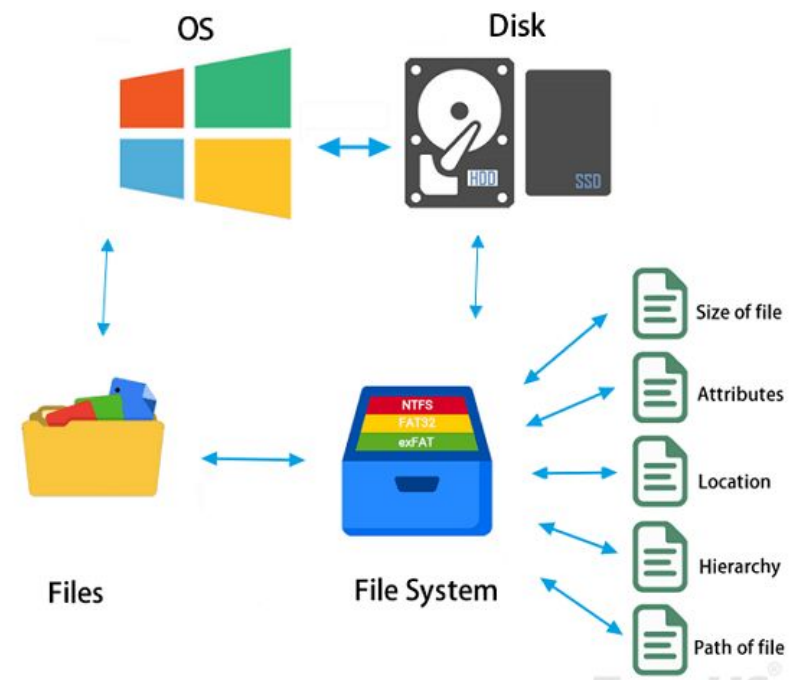
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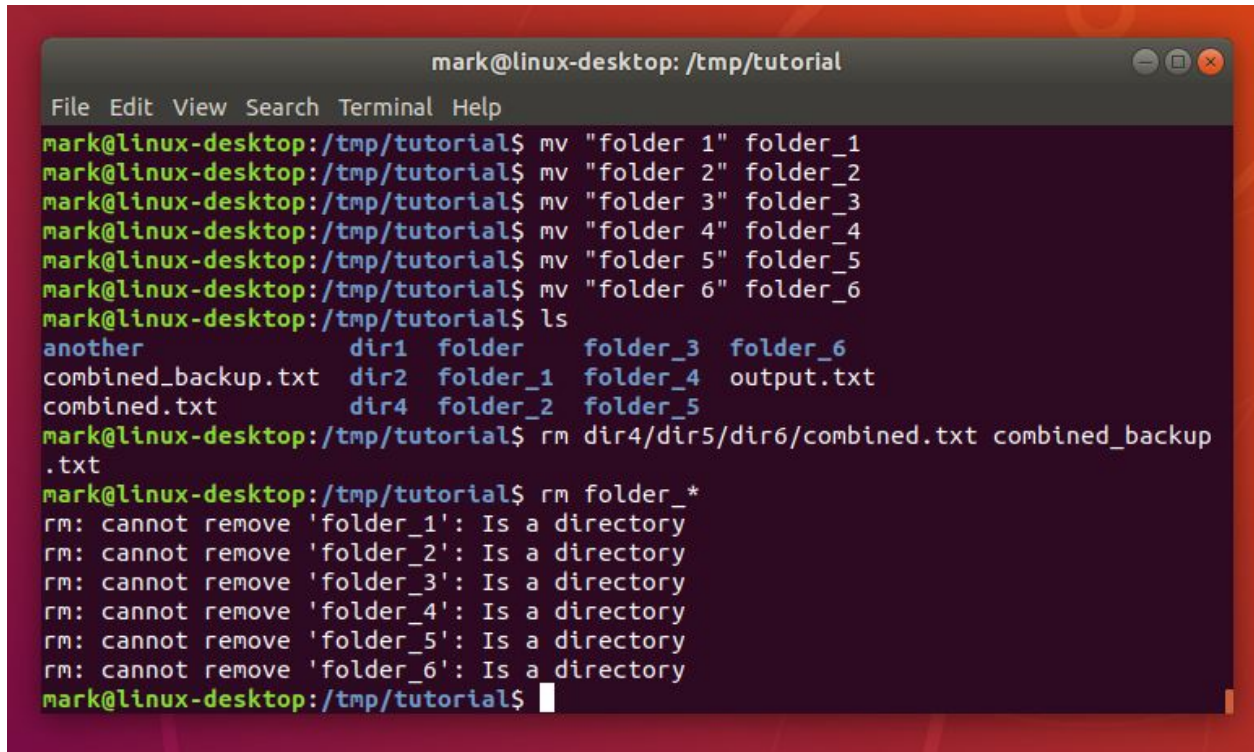
# Working with files

You **need** to understand how to work with files and folders

- Folders : organise files
- HD : a tree of folders and files
- Applications : executable program that uses i/o files

Actions : **view, create, or edit** (cut, copy, paste, deleting) files.

# What's this?

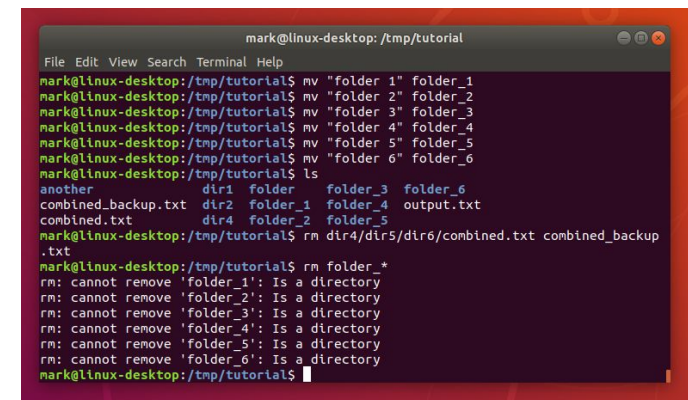
A terminal window titled 'mark@linux-desktop: /tmp/tutorial' with a menu bar (File, Edit, View, Search, Terminal, Help). The terminal shows a sequence of commands: moving 'folder 1' through 'folder 6' to 'folder\_1' through 'folder\_6', listing the directory contents, removing a file, and attempting to remove the folders. The output shows the directory listing and error messages for the removal attempts.

```
mark@linux-desktop: /tmp/tutorial
File Edit View Search Terminal Help
mark@linux-desktop:/tmp/tutorial$ mv "folder 1" folder_1
mark@linux-desktop:/tmp/tutorial$ mv "folder 2" folder_2
mark@linux-desktop:/tmp/tutorial$ mv "folder 3" folder_3
mark@linux-desktop:/tmp/tutorial$ mv "folder 4" folder_4
mark@linux-desktop:/tmp/tutorial$ mv "folder 5" folder_5
mark@linux-desktop:/tmp/tutorial$ mv "folder 6" folder_6
mark@linux-desktop:/tmp/tutorial$ ls
another          dir1  folder  folder_3  folder_6
combined_backup.txt  dir2  folder_1 folder_4  output.txt
combined.txt       dir4  folder_2 folder_5
mark@linux-desktop:/tmp/tutorial$ rm dir4/dir5/dir6/combined.txt combined_backup
.txt
mark@linux-desktop:/tmp/tutorial$ rm folder_*
rm: cannot remove 'folder_1': Is a directory
rm: cannot remove 'folder_2': Is a directory
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mark@linux-desktop:/tmp/tutorial$
```

Source : <https://ubuntu.com/tutorials/command-line-for-beginners>

# Terminal ( = Command Line)

1. A **text-based method**/interface to access information on your computer
2. A text input and output environment
3. A program that acts as a **wrapper** and allows to enter commands that the computer processes



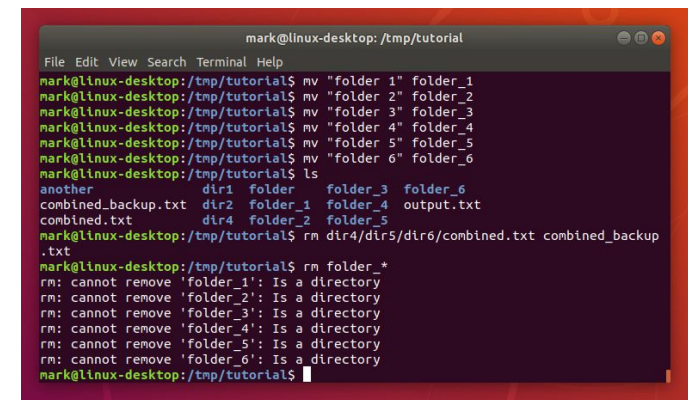
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mark@linux-desktop: /tmp/tutorial$ mv "folder 5" folder_5
mark@linux-desktop: /tmp/tutorial$ mv "folder 6" folder_6
mark@linux-desktop: /tmp/tutorial$ ls
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# Terminal ( = Command Line)

Actions:

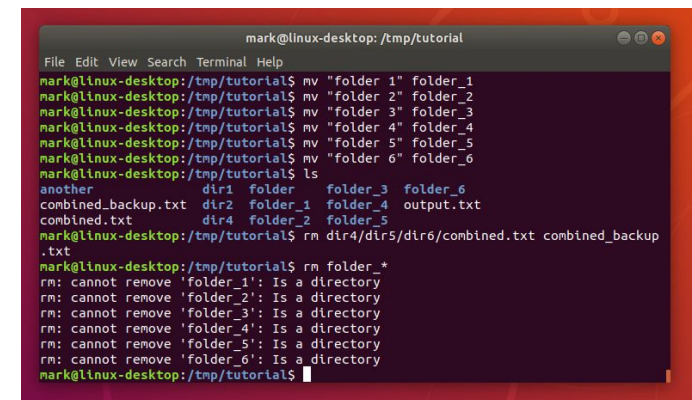
- type commands
- manipulate files
- execute programs

A terminal usually starts in the top-level directory of your user account!



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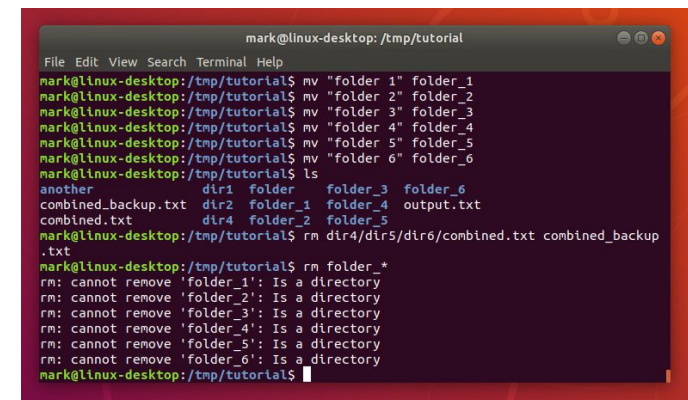
# Terminal : What for?



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```

# Terminal : What for?

- Faster, more efficient (i.e. creating sequences of commands to execute, i.e. a script)
- Task Automatisation (create a script today, run it tomorrow)
- Sometimes it is the only alternative (i.e. to communicate with remote servers)



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mark@linux-desktop:/tmp/tutorial$
```



# Opening a Terminal

All operating systems come with a default terminal installed

## Windows OS

write "cmd" in the search field  
or Type Windows+R keys

when the "run" appears,  
just type in "cmd"

Hit return

## Mac OS

Press the "Command" key and  
the space bar

type "Terminal" in the Spotlight  
bar

Hit return

NB **different terminal languages**!! MacOS/Linux :Bash. Windows:  
Powershell.

# Directories

You “move” around your file system content  
current directory : your working directory

Directories are separated by a slash /

The topmost directory = a single backslash.

```
/Volumes/ilaria/documents/Photos/
```

# Directories

Command + any modifiers/arguments required,  
hit return to execute the command

Eg :

`cd /` = move to top directory

`cd ..` = go 1 directory level up

`cd /Volumes/ilaria/Documents/Photos/` = ?

# Directories

`pwd` = print the complete pathname of the current directory

`ls` = listing documents

`ls .` = list all documents in current directory

`ls /Volumes/ilaria/Applications` = ?

# Directories

`cd <your_directory>` = change directory (move into it).

no arguments (`cd`): go to top-level home dir

`cd .` = move to current directory (do not move)

`cd ..` = move to parent directory (go up one directory in the file tree)

# Terminal Commands

`mv <from> <to>` : move a file from dir to dir

can also rename `mv myfile.txt myfile.csv`

`cp <from> <to>` : copy a file to a new location or name

`mkdir <directory name>` : make a directory

`rm` or `rmdir <directory name>` : remove a directory  
(the directory must be empty)

# Files and strings

`touch <filename>` : create new file

`less <filename>` : scroll through a file

`cat <filename>` : send/show the file to standard output (into the terminal)

`echo "a string"` : print string in the standard output

# Files and strings

```
Ilarias-Air:~ it2529$ echo "Hello"  
Hello  
Ilarias-Air:~ it2529$
```

Directing output: send stuff to a file using the greater than symbol  
(1 time `>` : write a new file, 2 times `>>` : append to existing file )

```
echo "you are a smart student" > smart.txt  
less smart.txt
```



# Exercise

```
cd ..
```

```
cd <foldername>
```

```
mkdir newfolder
```

```
ping google.com
```

```
(ctrl + Z to stop )
```

# Terminal Commands (Wildcards)

the star character `*` shows all the files in a directory

eg

List all files : `ls *`

List all files starting with A : `ls A*`

**Never type `rm *`**

# Terminal Commands (Wildcards)

## Tab completion

- when you have typed part of the name of a file, hitting the `tab` key will complete the filename as far as possible

eg. `/V<tab>i<tab>Doc>tab<` gets me  
`/Volumes/ilaria/Documents`

- If you have more files starting with the same sequence, tab completion will beep at you. If you hit `tab` again, then the terminal will show you the options

# Terminal Commands (ShortCuts)

`Ctrl+ a`: move to the beginning of the line

`Ctrl+e` : move to the end of the line

`Ctrl+b` : move back a character

`Ctrl+f` : move fwd a character

# Terminal Commands

Multiple commands together create a program (a small software)

A program can be saved as a **runnable script** file

Try

```
echo "Hello smart student" > my_script.sh  
sh my_script.sh
```

# Assignment

- Create a directory
- Create 1 or 2 text files (.txt)
- Paste text of your choice in the files
- Rename file
- Count words and list words by frequency
- Print a wordcloud with the list
- Save image
- Submit : the image (pdf, png) the frqList.txt file, the script (as a txt)

# Coming Lectures

## This Week

- Machine Learning by Peter Bloem
- Practice with Terminal
- Submit Literature Review!